

“Had the Americans **cut the Ho Chi Minh Trail** the **outcome of the war** would have been **far different.**”

ANDREW R. FINLAYSON, *RICE PADDY RECON: A MARINE OFFICER’S SECOND TOUR IN VIETNAM*, 1968–1970

» AFTER

As the war went on, severing the Ho Chi Minh Trail became a priority for the US.

TRAIL OF DESTRUCTION

Beginning in 1964, Royal Laotian, South Vietnamese, and US **warplanes bombed the trail** around the clock, making some 500 sorties a day. By late 1968, the number had doubled. Nevertheless, the trail stayed open and the supplies kept rolling. After each attack, hordes of Viet Cong soldiers and volunteers raced to repair the damage. **By 1972, the trail had been supplemented by a new Secret Road.**



THE HO CHIN MINH TRAIL TODAY